Toolkit
Music Production
Athens, Georgia
2023

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Plan of Work Log

TECHNOLOGY STUDENT ASSOCIATION PLAN OF WORK				
Date	Task	Time involved	Team member responsible (student initials)	Comments
12/17/2022 1.	Beat Making	6 Hours	A.M.	The beat-making process is the most essential part of the song. This helps give inspiration for writing lyrics to the song. The beat has to be high quality and allow the songwriters to freely write lyrics. This process took me 6 hours. Experimenting with different tempos, melodies, and drums takes a lot of time. This will eventually lead to the "perfect" beat.
12/24/2022 2.	Writing	3.2 Hours	A.M.	Writing this song was one of the most important parts of the song. Writing this song to be eligible for being played in the TSA national conference was interesting. Eventually, I made my song about all the competitors, working hard, teamwork, and the prize that it all comes down to.
1/7/2023 3.	Organizing	4 Hours	A.M.	Organizing a song is an important aspect of music composition and production because it helps determine the piece's structure and flow. A well-organized song has a clear beginning, middle, and end, and the different sections are arranged in a way that makes sense to the listener. An organized song also helps to reinforce the melody and lyrics, as well as the underlying rhythm.
1/14/2023 4.	Recording	5 Hours	A.M.	Recording a song is important because it allows the composer to preserve and share their music, and helps to establish their creative identity and legacy. In addition, recording a song can also help to establish the song's unique sound and style.
1/21/2023 5.	Mixing	8 Hours	A.M.	Mixing a song is important in the music production process because it involves balancing and blending the various audio elements in a recording, such as the vocals, instruments, and sound effects. The mixing process can significantly impact the sound and feel of a song, and it can help to enhance the overall musical experience for the listener. This is often the longest part of making a song.
1/30/2023 6.	Mastering	3 Hours	A.M.	Mastering a song is the final stage of the music production process and is an important part of the song because it helps to refine and optimize the overall sound of the recording. Mastering involves applying technical and creative processes to enhance the overall balance, volume, clarity, and impact of the mix. By mastering the song, the sound will be well received by listeners.

Advisor signature _____

Self Evaluation

TIER 1 – MUSICAL PIECE (70 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Creativity and Uniqueness (X1)	The musical idea is overly familiar or is a cliché; no variety or exploration of musical elements (range, timbre, dynamics, tempo, rhythm, and melody) are evident.	The work involves some original aspects or manipulations of musical ideas; it explores and includes at least one (1) or more musical elements.	The piece includes highly original, unusual, or imaginative musical ideas; it explores and includes at least two (2) or more musical elements.	10
Artisanship (X1)	The piece gives no sense of a completed musical idea; there is no clear beginning, middle, or end section; the form appears random, rather than organized.	One (1) musical element has been used to organize the musical ideas and overall form, which are somewhat coherent.	The piece presents at least one (1) complete musical idea; the piece has a coherent and organized form with a clear beginning, middle, and end; musical elements are used to organize the musical ideas and form.	10
Energy and Style (X2)	The piece lacks liveliness, vitality, and vigor; there is no flair, elegance, or grace to the form.	The piece generates an initial level of energy that appeals to the listener; the style is somewhat distinctive.	The liveliness and forcefulness of the piece excite the listener; the style is truly unique and electrifying.	10
Appropriateness (X1)	The musical idea or concept is not appropriate and acceptable for use in the event.	The musical idea or concept presented is acceptable and somewhat fitting.	The musical idea or concept presented is fitting and serves as an excellent example of the type of work expected.	10
Overall Appeal (X2)	The work does not present an effective general impression; the musical ideas do not hold the listener's interest.	The work includes some interesting musical ideas; the general impression is pleasant and moderately effective.	There is strong, interesting, and effective audio appeal; the work is designed to be enjoyed by the listeners.	10
			TIER 1 – MUSICAL PIECE SUBTOTAL (70 points)	70

Lyrics

Yeah I know that you knew this
When Avi on the track why these people always clueless?
Though I'm working with me and my toolkit
Shoutout to the teams and the people who are students

Though I came to the scene to go on the top
Imma give my support to all the ones who worked a lot
All these people competing but one gets the spot
It's hard when you playing chess and then they check you off
Stay relentless and never stop moving
Cuz if you keep working hard you'll be cruising
I be studying and working on my music
They all ask me, are we gonna win? You bet!

Yeah I know that you knew this
When Avi on the track why these people always clueless?
Though I'm working with me and my toolkit
Shoutout to the teams and the people who are students

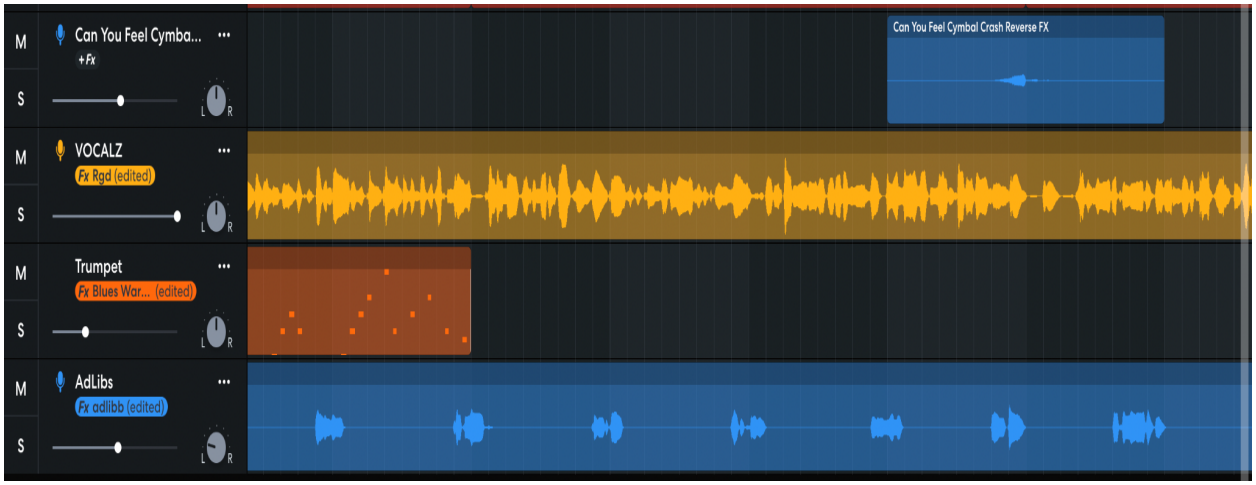
When we work a lot you know we'll get the rock
You know we all gon top
We gon have the number 1 spot
When I rap yeah you know we gotta relapse
We gotta run back these laps
And why these people all-all laugh?
They don't know that I gotta make everything perfect
So that everyone will know that I'm deserving
All these snakes around me they don't think I see em lurking
I have to make the best decision so that I am worth it

Yeah I know that you knew this
When Avi on the track why these people always clueless?
Though I'm working with me and my toolkit
Shoutout to the teams and the people who are students

They don't believe that we can get the 1 spot
Imma prove them all wrong, watch the clock tock
They said I can't make it nice and make it a bop
And when they throw their stones, know that imma never flop
One day I was tryna get my head around this
I woke up, someone said: "success is found kid"
But there's a long way to go before I sound it
With my determination imma climb mountains

Yeah I know that you knew this
When Avi on the track why these people always clueless?
Though I'm working with me and my toolkit
Shoutout to the teams and the people who are students

Audio Composition Tracklist



Musical Elements

First, I set the tap tempo to 142 BPM. Then, for the melody, I used my MIDI Keyboard to make a Xylophone track on Bandlab that added a playful and upbeat tone to the song. This was panned slightly to the right.

Next, I added a guitar base layer for the song, which repeated throughout the track. This guitar was in the F minor key and had a equalizer and compressor added to it to make it sound better and more smooth. This was panned slightly to the right.

Then, I added a baseline with my MIDI Keyboard which I adjusted to make it sound like a Bass guitar on Bandlab. The notes that I used for this baseline were all on Octave 1 and in the A major key. This was panned to the center.

Afterwards, I added a drumline which only consisted of the clap and kick sounds to add a simple, but catchy rhythm to the song. This track was panned to the center.

While I was creating this drumline, I thought of making a more fun and pop type of sound, so, I added a shaker to the song, which I labeled as the Lofi Percussion 03. This added a natural twist to the song. This track was panned to the center.

Next, to make the song stand out, I added an alt pop hat sound which gave a transition exiter and a nice and unique feel to the song. This track was panned to the center.

Then, I added a cymbal crash. This allowed for more boost when I am shifting from verse to chorus or from chorus to verse. This crash added a build-up to the song which adds excitement and energy to the song. This track was panned to the center.

After I finished recording my vocals, I wanted to add a funky tone to the melody. So, I added a trumpet melody which incorporated the same notes as the original xylophone melody. To make this melody sound subtle and not too forced, I added a noise gate, used an amplifier, and used a reverb tool that was provided to me by Bandlab. This track was panned to the center.

List of Hardware, Software, and Instruments

Software used for this project: Bandlab (www .bandlab.com)

Hardware used for this project: Yeti Blue Microphone, iPhone, Akai MPK Mini MK3 25-Key Midi Keyboard Controller, and Macbook Air.

Instruments used for this project: Xylophone, Trumpet, Guitar, Bass, and Drums

References

•I used the software Bandlab for this project. All aspects of this project are mine. I recorded my verses with my own lyrics, made the beat with the tools provided to me in Bandlab, and mixed/mastered the song on my own. This song that I named “Toolkit” is my work.

•ALL WORK IS COPYRIGHT FREE AND MANIPULATED WITH THE TOOLS OF THE SOFTWARE TO CREATE.

(ROYALTY FREE)

•Links used: https://www.bandlab.com/

STUDENT COPYRIGHT CHECKLIST

(for students to complete and advisors to verify)

1) **Does your solution to the competitive event integrate any music?** ☐ YES ☐ NO

   If NO, go to question 2.

   If YES, is the music copyrighted? ☐ YES ☐ NO

   If YES, move to question 1A. If NO, move to question 1B.

   1A) Have you asked for author permission to use the music in your solution and included that permission (letter/form) in your documentation? If YES, move to question 2. If NO, ask for permission (OR use royalty free/your own original music) and if permission is granted, include the permission in your documentation.

   1B) Is the music royalty free, or did you create the music yourself? If YES, cite the royalty free music OR your original music properly in your documentation.

CHAPTER ADVISOR: Sign below if your student has integrated any music into his/her competitive event solution.

I, _____ (chapter advisor), have checked my student's solution and confirm that the use of music is done so with proper permission and is cited correctly in the student's documentation.

2) Does your solution to the competitive event integrate any graphics? ☐ YES ☐ NO

   If NO, go to question 3.

   If YES, is the graphic copyrighted, registered and/or trademarked? ☐ YES ☐ NO

   If YES, move to question 2A. If NO, move to question 2B.

   2A) Have you asked for author permission to use the graphic in your solution and included that permission (letter/form) in your documentation? If YES, move to question 3. If NO, ask for permission (OR use royalty free/your own original graphic) and if permission is granted, include the permission in your documentation.

   2B) Is the graphic royalty free, or did you create your own graphic? If YES, cite the royalty free graphic OR your own original graphic properly in your documentation.

CHAPTER ADVISOR: Sign below if your student has integrated any graphics into his/her competitive event solution.

I, _____ (chapter advisor), have checked my student's solution and confirm that the use of graphics is done so with proper permission and is cited correctly in the student's documentation.

3) Does your solution to the competitive event use another's thoughts or research? ☐ YES ☐ NO

   If NO, this is the end of the checklist.

   If YES, have you properly cited other's thoughts or research in your documentation? If YES, this is the end of the checklist.

   If NO, properly cite the thoughts/research of others in your documentation.

CHAPTER ADVISOR: Sign below if your student has integrated any thoughts/research of others into his/her competitive event solution.

I, _____ (chapter advisor), have checked my student's solution and confirm that the use of the thoughts/research of others is done so with proper permission and is cited correctly in the student's documentation.